

Day 12 — Wed 16 Sep

Countdown: 10 days to General English & GK

Method: start by recalling yesterday's topic with this page closed. Study the sections below, work every example by hand, then do 20 MCQs.

🕒 GK — History I

Source: General/03_GK_CAPSULE.md

4.1 Ancient India (headline facts)

Period	Must-know facts
Indus Valley / Harappan (c. 2500–1900 BCE)	Bronze Age; planned cities (Harappa , Mohenjo-daro , Dholavira , Lothal); great bath; drainage; script undeciphered; on the Sindhu (Indus)
Vedic Age (c. 1500–600 BCE)	Aryans; the four Vedas (Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva); Rig Veda oldest; caste (varna) system emerges
Buddhism / Jainism (6th c. BCE)	Gautama Buddha (Four Noble Truths, Eightfold Path; enlightenment at Bodh Gaya); Mahavira (24th Tirthankara of Jainism)
Mauryan Empire (322–185 BCE)	Founded by Chandragupta Maurya (guided by Chanakya/Kautilya , <i>Arthashastra</i>); Ashoka — Kalinga War → Buddhism; rock edicts; Sarnath Lion Capital = national emblem
Gupta Empire (c. 320–550 CE)	" Golden Age "; Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) ; Aryabhata (zero, astronomy), Kalidasa ; decimal system

4.2 Medieval India (headline facts)

Period	Must-know facts
Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526)	Five dynasties — Slave, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi; Qutb-ud-din Aibak (Qutub Minar); Alauddin Khilji (market reforms)
Vijayanagara & Bahmani	Southern kingdoms; Krishnadevaraya (Vijayanagara)
Mughal Empire (1526–1857)	Babur (won 1st Battle of Panipat, 1526); Akbar (<i>Din-i-Ilahi</i> , Mansabdari); Shah Jahan (Taj Mahal); Aurangzeb (largest extent, then decline)
Marathas	Shivaji — founder of the Maratha empire; guerrilla warfare
Bhakti & Sufi movements	Kabir, Guru Nanak, Mirabai, Chaitanya; devotional, anti-caste, syncretic

4.4 Naga / North-East angle in history

- **Battle of Kohima (1944)** — a decisive WWII battle that helped halt the Japanese advance into India; commemorated at the **Kohima War Cemetery** with the famous epitaph. Frequently pairs history with Nagaland GK.
- The Naga political timeline (§3.1) can itself be asked as "modern history of the

North-East."

History — likely exam questions

- [5] Why is the Revolt of 1857 called the First War of Independence?
- [5] Write a note on the Dandi Salt March.
- [10] Describe the main phases of the Indian freedom struggle from 1919 to 1947.
- [5] What was the significance of the Battle of Kohima (1944)?

History — MCQ traps (with answers)

Answers

1. INC founded in? → **1885** 2. Jallianwala Bagh massacre year & city? → **1919, Amritsar** 3. Quit India Movement year? → **1942** 4. First Battle of Panipat? → **1526 (Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi)** 5. National emblem is adapted from? → **Ashoka's Lion Capital at Sarnath** 6. "Golden Age of India" refers to? → **Gupta period** 7. Who declared "Swaraj is my birthright"? → **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** 8. Salt March started from? → **Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi (1930)**

SECTION 5 — INDIAN ECONOMY

Intuition first. Economics questions in a state GK paper are conceptual and definitional, not quantitative. Know *what each term means* and *which body does what*.

Core — synchronisation & deadlock

Study [_Shared/CORE_03_OperatingSystems.md](#) today (section match not found — open the full topic PDF for: synchron, semaphore, deadlock, mutual, critical).